Unit 7 — Mediation: A German News Article

Track G+M · Klasse 9 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can mediate a German news article into 5–7 English sentences for a peer.*
- *I can keep facts, drop ceremony, and adjust register.*
- *I can use 6 reporting verbs (says, explains, claims, points out, warns, recommends).*

Lead-in I

Naima’s German uncle forwarded a news article about a bus-route change. Her English-speaking cousin in Toronto needed to know whether her *favourite shop* was still reachable. Naima translated nothing. She explained.

Vocabulary I

- to say
- to explain
- to mention
- to claim
- to advise
- to warn
- to recommend
- to point out
- to stress
- to add
- to deny

Reading I

Source — *German news article (excerpt)*
Die Stadtverwaltung hat angekündigt, dass die Linie 42 ab dem 1. September einen neuen Fahrplan haben wird. Die Buslinie wird zwei zusätzliche Haltestellen im Stadtteil Ost bedienen. Die Fahrtzeit verlängert sich dadurch um etwa fünf Minuten. Pendler werden gebeten, die neue Verbindung im Online-Fahrplan zu überprüfen.

Mediation rules — Klasse 9 version

1. *Who is reading?* — register, formality.
2. *What do they need?* — keep facts, drop decoration.

Reading II

3. *What is the smallest version?* — without losing meaning.
4. *Are there cultural notes that need explaining?*

Reporting verbs (extended)
to say, to explain, to mention, to claim, to advise, to warn, to recommend, to point out, to stress, to add, to deny.

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Match German verb to English: *bestreiten — ?, betonen — ?, hinzufügen — ?, mahnen — ?*.
2. Choose: *say / claim / explain / warn* — The article _____ that the route will change. Critics _____ that this will hurt elderly passengers.

Niveau M

3. Build a 5-sentence English mediation of the source article above.

Your turn I

mediation (”Mediation”), 6–7 sentences. Read the German source above. Write 6–7 English sentences for a Canadian friend who has asked whether a particular bus stop is still reachable. Use 4 reporting verbs.

Sample

Hi Jo, here’s the gist of the article. The city council has announced a new timetable for bus line 42, starting 1 September. The article explains that two extra stops are being added in the eastern part of town. It mentions the journey will be about five minutes longer. Officials advise passengers to check the online schedule. The article also points out that all current stops are kept, so your favourite shop should still be reachable. The change starts in two weeks.

Reflect I

- I can mediate a German article into 6 English sentences.
- I can drop ceremony and keep facts.
- I can use 4 reporting verbs.

Further reading / listening I

- Goethe-Institut — Beispiel-Aufgaben language mediation (Sprachmittlung).
- Landesbildungsserver BW — mediation (”Mediation”)-Beispielaufgaben.